AI SponsorMatched Streaming Service

BENCH

Background

An AI-powered sports streaming platform that connects fans with live content and matches sports creators directly with relevant brand sponsors . Built from zero as founding product designer.

Role

Founding Product Designer

Timeline

6 months

Stakeholders

1 product manager, 2 Engineers, 1 product designer(me)

Discovering User Needs

Three distinct audiences — Fans, Creators, and Sponsors — each with entirely different goals, pain points, and mental models. Understanding all three was the prerequisite to designing anything.

Creator

Sports Content Creator

Produces game highlights, analysis, and live commentary. Engaged audience but no efficient path to brand deals. Manages streaming, monetization and sponsorships across disconnected tools

- **No sponsor pipeline**
- **Revenue fragmented**
- **Manual outreach**

Sponsors

Brand / Marketing Team

Has campaign budget for sports audiences but no scalable way to discover and vet relevant creators. Process relies on agencies or cold outreach — slow, expensive, low signal-to-noise.

- **No discovery tool**
- **Poor ROI targeting**
- **Agency dependent**

Fan

Sports Fan / Viewer

Wants live sports, niche leagues, and creator driven highlights in one place. Currently juggling multiple apps and subscriptions to follow teams, athletes, and creators they care about.

- **Subscription fatigue**
- **Fragmented content**
- **High engagement**

Problem Resources

PROBLEM RESOURCES Existing platforms like YouTube, Twitch, and ESPN+ serve fans well but provide zero infrastructure for creator monetization through sponsorships. The creator-to-sponsor relationship remains entirely manual, relationship-dependent, and inaccessible to mid-tier creators — the fastest growing segment of sports content creation. Creators spend an estimated 8–12 hours per week on sponsorship admin alone — time that directly reduces content output and platform growth.

Goals

Usability, Feasibility, Clarity

Fans, Creators, and Sponsors each had different expectations and behaviors, requiring a platform that felt intuitive, clear, and seamless across all experiences.

Research, Brainstorms, Workflow and Wireframes

From early research synthesis through "How Might We" framing, user flow mapping, and wireframe explorations, documenting the thinking behind every design decision.

KEY INSIGHTS & HMW QUESTIONS

Creator Discovery Gap

Mid-tier creators (10k–500k) have highest growth rate but zero access to structured sponsorship pipelines. Sponsor Targeting Failure

Sponsor Targeting Failure

72% of sports brands report creator partnerships underperform due to audience mismatch, not budget.

Unified Platform Demand

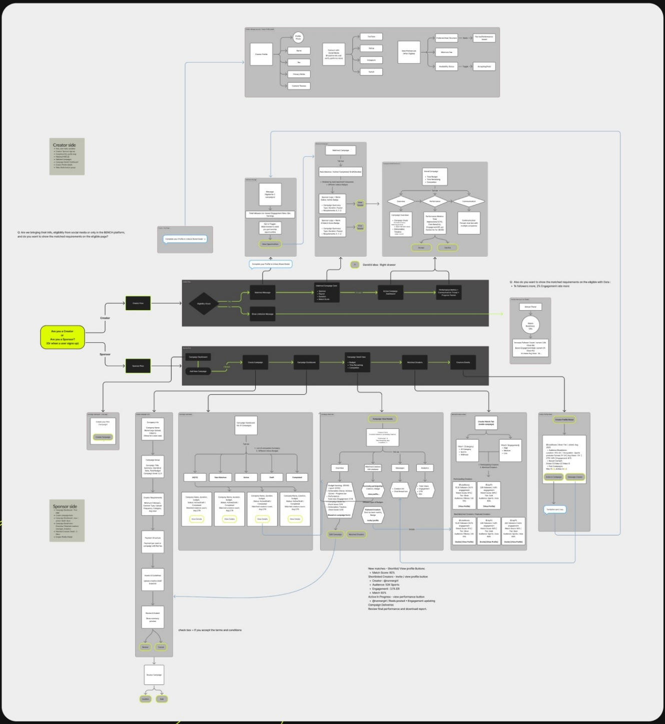
Creators use 3–5 separate tools to manage streaming, analytics, monetization, and brand deals.

HOW MIGHT WE

- ☆ Help creators discover relevant sponsors without cold outreach or agency fees?
- ☆ Give sponsors confidence that creator audiences match their target demographic before committing budget?
- ☆ Unify streaming, monetization, and sponsorship tracking so creators need only one platform? HMW make AI matching fee
- ☆ make AI matching feel transparent and trustworthy “not a black box” for both sides?

RESEARCH FINDINGS

SPONSORMATCH WORKFLOW — CREATOR & SPONSORFLOW


Creator side
Q: Are we bringing their info, eligibility from social media or only in the BENCH platform, and do you want to show the matched requirements on the eligible page?
Complete your Profile to Unlock Brand Deals!
Are you a Creator
or
Are you a Sponsor?
(Or when a user signs up)
Creator
Sponsor
Creator Flow
Sponsor Flow
Eligibility Check
Matched Message
Show Limitation Message
Campaign Dashboard
Add New Campaign
Create Campaign
David's idea: Right drawer
Q: Also do you want to show the matched requirements on the eligible with Data :
• 1k followers more, 2% Engagement rate more
Sponsor side
Create your first Campaign!
Company Info
Campaign Dashboard
list of Campaigns
check box + if you accept the terms and conditions
Matched Creators
New matches - Shortlist/ View profile Buttons
• Match Score: 92%
Shortlisted Creators - Invite / view profile button
• Creator : @runnergirl
• Audience: 52K Sports
• Engagement : 3.1% ER
• Match 92%
Active In Progress - view performance button
• @runnergirl / Reels posted • Engagement updating
Campaign Deliveries
Review final performance and download report.

What is the MVP?

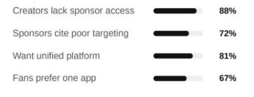
FEATURE INSIGHTS

Three core product surfaces needed to launch: the public-facing streaming homepage for fan acquisition, the AI SponsorMatch system for creator-sponsor pairing, and the creator dashboard for ongoing monetization management. Content Post, Pricing for Sponsors and Creators.

PROPOSAL SKETCHES

Early explorations tested two IA directions: a rolegated experience (separate apps per user type) vs. a unified app with contextual role switching. Testing confirmed the unified model, shared navigation reinforced the platform's value prop of being one place for all sports stakeholders.

RESEARCH INSIGHTS



ITERATIVE DESIGN LEARNING

→ Eligibility gating for monetization needed to show creators exactly which criteria they were missing: vague rejection states destroyed trust in early testing.

→ Sponsors needed AI match rationale surfaced clearly: without transparency on why a creator was recommended, sponsors rejected the recommendations entirely.

→ The content upload flow required an explicit broadcast rights check step: without it, creators risked post-publish takedowns, a critical trust-breaking event.

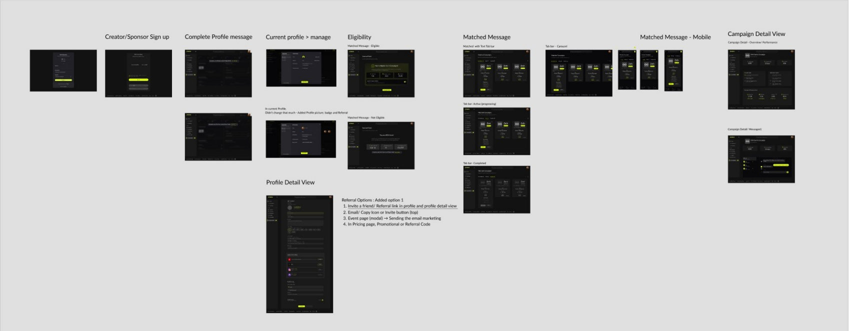
DESIGN TAKEAWAYS

The most important early decision was treating Bench as a **dual-sided marketplace** first, streaming platform second. Every screen was evaluated against how it served all three user types. Designing the AI SponsorMatch meant making algorithmic matching feel human and legible, surfacing compatibility scores, audience overlap data, and giving both sides agency in the match process rather than presenting the AI as a black box. Building the design system before any feature screens was the highest-leverage investment: the 50+ screens across all flows were designed with speed and consistency only because the full component library was established first.

The Core Innovation — Two Sides, One Match

AI SPONSORMATCH

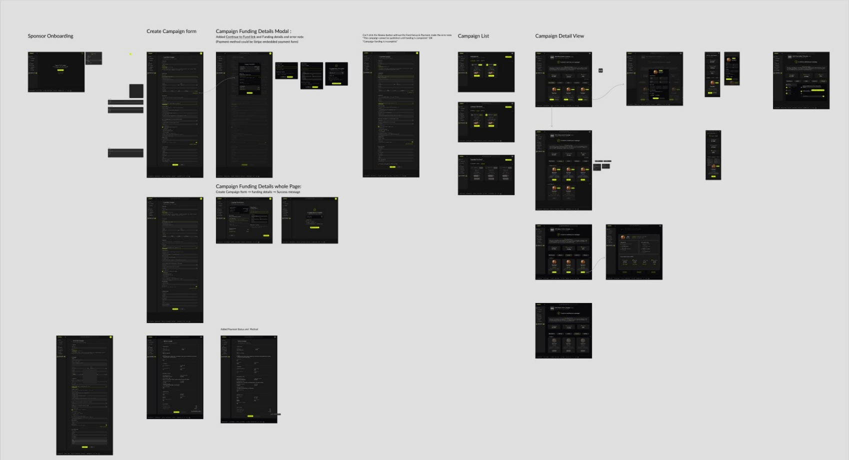
⚡ Creator Side **Find Your Brand Deal**


Creator/Sponsor Sign up
Complete Profile message
Current profile > manage
Eligibility
Matched Message - Eligible
Matched Message - Not Eligible
Profile Detail View
Matched Message
Matched with Text Tab bar
Tab bar - Carousel
Tab bar- Active (progressing)
Tab bar- Completed
Matched Message - Mobile
Campaign Detail View
Campaign Detail - Overview/ Performance
Campaign Detail/ Message1

In current Profile,
Didn't change that much - Added Profile picture, badge and Referral

Referral Options : Added option 1
1. Invite a friend/ Referral link in profile and profile detail view
2. Email/ Copy Icon or Invite button (top)
3. Event page (modal) → Sending the email marketing
4. In Pricing page, Promotional or Referral Code

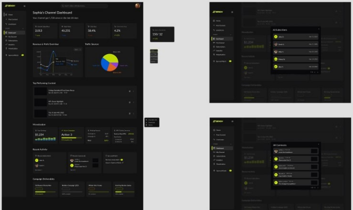
Sponsor Side Reach the Right Creator

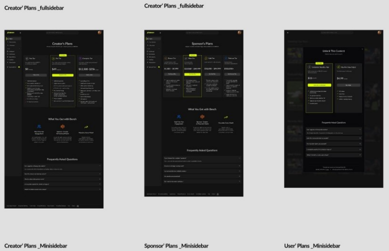

Sponsor Onboarding
Create Campaign form
Campaign Funding Details Modal :
Added Continue to Fund link and Funding details and error note
(Payment method could be Stripe embedded payment form)
Can't click the Review button without the Fund Setup & Payment, made the error note
"This campaign cannot be published until funding is completed." OR
"Campaign funding is incomplete"
Campaign List
Campaign Detail View
Campaign Funding Details whole Page:
Create Campaign form → funding details → Success message
Added Payment Status and Method

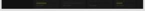
Channels - Dashboard & Monetization

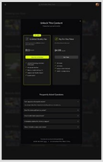
Real-time channel analytics, revenue performance, and a full monetization suite covering Ads, Sponsorships, PPV, and Payouts.

DASHBOARD : analytics, revenue, sponsorship activity


Sophia's Channel Dashboard
2,013
45,231
38.4%
4.2%
150/ 12
Revenue & Profit Overview
Traffic Sources
Top Performing Content
Monetization
$1,234
Active: 3
Recent Activity
Campaign Deliverables

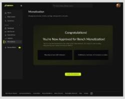

Creator' Plans _fullsidebar
Creator' Plans _fullsidebar
Creator's Plans
Sponsor's Plans
Unlock This Content
Creator' Plans _Minisidebar
Sponsor' Plans _Minisidebar
User' Plans _Minisidebar



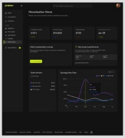


PRICING: creator, sponsor, fan, ppv

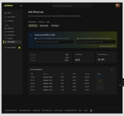
Eligibility
- —Not Eligible
- —Eligible

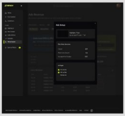


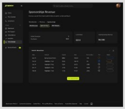
Monetization Home

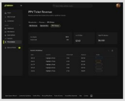


Monetization> Revenue
- —Ads / Ads Setup
- —Sponsorships
- —PPV

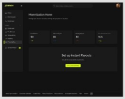


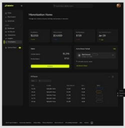


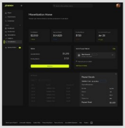




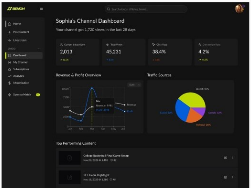
Monetization> Payout
- —Setup
- —Payout
- —Payout Details (Slide-in Drawer or Modal)







MONETIZATION: eligibility, ads, sponsorships, ppv, payout


BENCH
Search videos, athletes, teams...
Home
Post Content
Livestream
STUDIO
Dashboard
My Channel
Subscriptions
Analytics
Monetization
SponsorMatch

Sophia's Channel Dashboard

Your channel got 1,720 views in the last 28 days

Current Subscribers	Total Views	Click Rate	Conversion Rate
2,013	45,231	38.4%	4.2%
			+12%

Revenue & Profit Overview

Date
10000
7500
5000
2500
0
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
May
Jun
Mar
Revenue
Profit

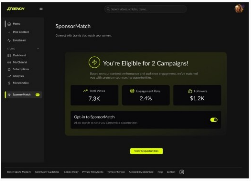
Traffic Sources

Direct: 40%
Social: 30%
Search: 10%
Referral: 20%

Top Performing Content

College Basketball Final Game Recap
Nov 20, 2025 1,450 87

NFL Game Highlight
Nov 18, 2025 1,280 45


BENCH
Search videos, athletes, teams...
Home
Post Content
Livestream
STUDIO
Dashboard
My Channel
Subscriptions
Analytics
Monetization
SponsorMatch

SponsorMatch

Connect with brands that match your content

You're Eligible for 2 Campaigns!

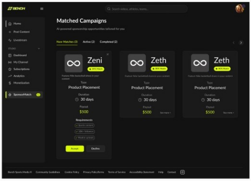
Based on your content performance and audience engagement, we've matched you with premium sponsorship opportunities.

Total Views	Engagement Rate	Followers
7.3K	2.4%	$1.2K

Opt-in to SponsorMatch

Allow brands to send you partnership opportunities

View Opportunities
Bench Sports Media ©
Community Guidelines
Cookie Policy
Privacy Policy/Terms
Terms of Service
Accessibility Statement
Help
Contact


BENCH
Search videos, athletes, teams...
Home
Post Content
Livestream
STUDIO
Dashboard
My Channel
Subscriptions
Analytics
Monetization
SponsorMatch

Matched Campaigns

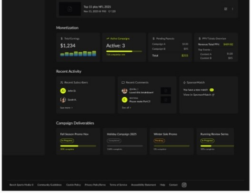
AI-powered sponsorship opportunities tailored for you

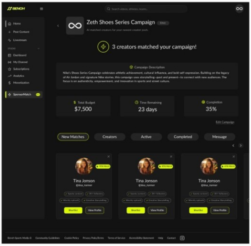
New Matches (3)
Active (2)
Completed (2)

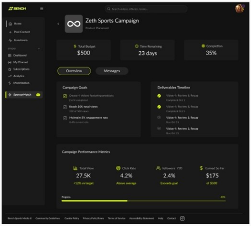
Zeni	Zeth	Zeth
Feature Nike basketball shoes in your content	Feature Nike basketball shoes in your content	Feature Nike basketball shoes in your content
Type	Type	Type
Product Placement	Product Placement	Product Placement
Duration	Duration	Duration
30 days	30 days	30 days
Payout	Payout	Payout
$500	$500	$500

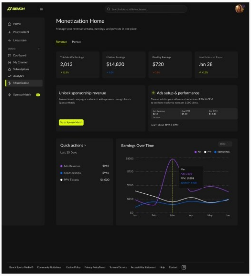
Requirements

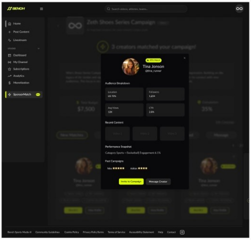
Sports content
10K+ followers
Weekly uploads
Accept
Decline
See more
See more
Bench Sports Media ©
Community Guidelines
Cookie Policy
Privacy Policy/Terms
Terms of Service
Accessibility Statement
Help
Contact

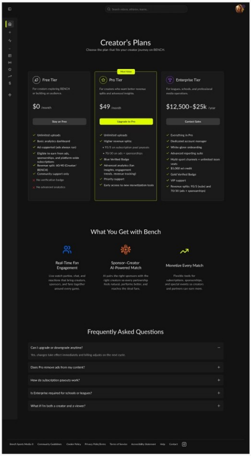

Top 15 play NFL 2025
Monetization
Total Earnings
$1,234
Active Campaigns
Active: 3
Pending Payouts
PPV Tickets Overview
Recent Activity
Recent Subscribers
Recent Comments
SponsorMatch
Campaign Deliverables
Fall Season Promo Nov
Holiday Campaign 2025
Winter Sale Promo
Running Review Series

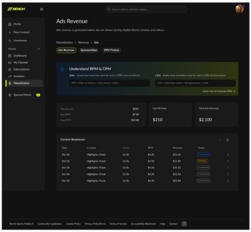

BENCH
Zeth Shoes Series Campaign
3 creators matched your campaign!
Campaign Description
Total Budget
$7,500
Time Remaining
23 days
Completion
35%
Edit Campaign
New Matches
Creators
Active
Completed
Message
Tina Jonson
@tina_runner
Shortlist
View Profile

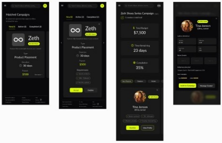

BENCH
Zeth Sports Campaign
Product Placement
Total Budget
$500
Time Remaining
23 days
Completion
35%
Overview
Messages
Campaign Goals
Deliverables Timeline
Campaign Performance Metrics
Total View
27.5K
Click Rate
4.2%
Followers
2.4%
Earned So Far
$175
of $500


BENCH
Monetization Home
Manage your revenue streams, earnings, and payouts in one place.
Revenue
Payout
2,013
$14,820
$720
Jan 28
Unlock sponsorship revenue
Go to SponsorMatch
Ads setup & performance
Quick actions
Last 30 Days
Ads Revenue
$210
Sponsorships
$948
PPV Tickets
$1,020
Earnings Over Time
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
May


Tina Jonson
@tina_runner
Audience Breakdown
Recent Content
Performance Snapshot
Past Campaigns
Invite to Campaign
Message Creator

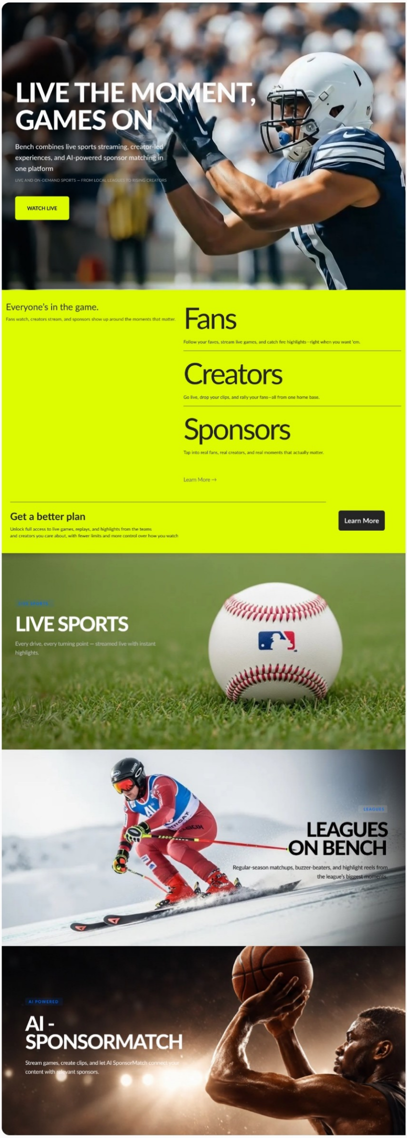

Creator's Plans
Choose the plan that fits your creator journey on BENCH.
Free Tier
$0 /month
Stay on Free
Pro Tier
$49 /month
Upgrade to Pro
Enterprise Tier
$12,500–$25k /year
Contact Sales
What You Get with Bench
Real-Time Fan Engagement
Sponsor–Creator AI-Powered Match
Monetize Every Match
Frequently Asked Questions
Can I upgrade or downgrade anytime?
Does Pro remove ads from my content?
How do subscription payouts work?
Is Enterprise required for schools or leagues?
What if I'm both a creator and a viewer?


BENCH
Ads Revenue
Ads Revenue
Sponsorships
PPV Tickets
Understand RPM & CPM
$210
$2,100
Content Breakdown


Matched Campaigns
Zeth
Product Placement
30 days
$500
Zeth Shoes Series Campaign
$7,500
23 days
35%
Tina Jonson

Homepage

Two states, one system — a high-energy marketing surface for new visitors and a personalized streaming hub once logged in. Both share the same visual language while serving fundamentally different user intents.


WATCH LIVE
Learn More →
Learn More
LIVE SPORTS
LEAGUES
AI POWERED

LIVE THE MOMENT, GAMES ON

Bench combines live sports streaming, creator-led experiences, and AI-powered sponsor matching in one platform

LIVE AND ON-DEMAND SPORTS — FROM LOCAL LEAGUES TO RISING CREATORS

Everyone's in the game.

Fans watch, creators stream, and sponsors show up around the moments that matter.

Fans

Follow your faves, stream live games, and catch fire highlights—right when you want 'em.

Creators

Go live, drop your clips, and rally your fans—all from one home base.

Sponsors

Tap into real fans, real creators, and real moments that actually matter.

Get a better plan

Unlock full access to live games, replays, and highlights from the teams
and creators you care about, with fewer limits and more control over how you watch

LIVE SPORTS

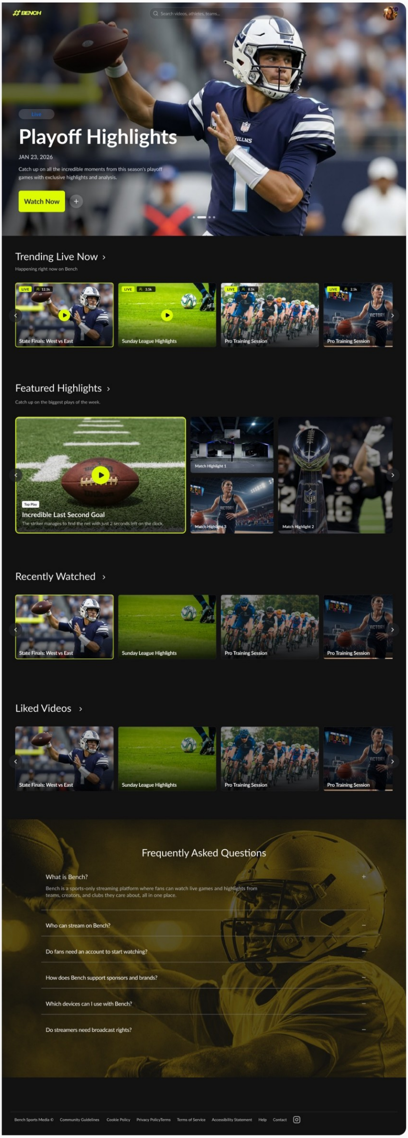
Every drive, every turning point — streamed live with instant highlights.

LEAGUES ON BENCH

Regular-season matchups, buzzer-beaters, and highlight reels from the league's biggest moments.

AI - SPONSORMATCH

Stream games, create clips, and let AI SponsorMatch connect your content with relevant sponsors.


BENCH
Search videos, athletes, teams...
Live
Watch Now
+
LIVE
12.5k
LIVE
3.5k
LIVE
8.5k
LIVE
2.5k
State Finals: West vs East
Sunday League Highlights
Pro Training Session
Pro Training Session
Top Play
Match Highlight 1
Match Highlight 3
Match Highlight 2
State Finals: West vs East
Sunday League Highlights
Pro Training Session
Pro Training Session
State Finals: West vs East
Sunday League Highlights
Pro Training Session
Pro Training Session

Playoff Highlights

JAN 23, 2026

Catch up on all the incredible moments from this season's playoff games with exclusive highlights and analysis.

Trending Live Now ›

Happening right now on Bench

Featured Highlights ›

Catch up on the biggest plays of the week.

Incredible Last Second Goal

The striker manages to find the net with just 2 seconds left on the clock.

Recently Watched ›

Liked Videos ›

Frequently Asked Questions

What is Bench? +

Bench is a sports-only streaming platform where fans can watch live games and highlights from teams, creators, and clubs they care about, all in one place.

Who can stream on Bench? –

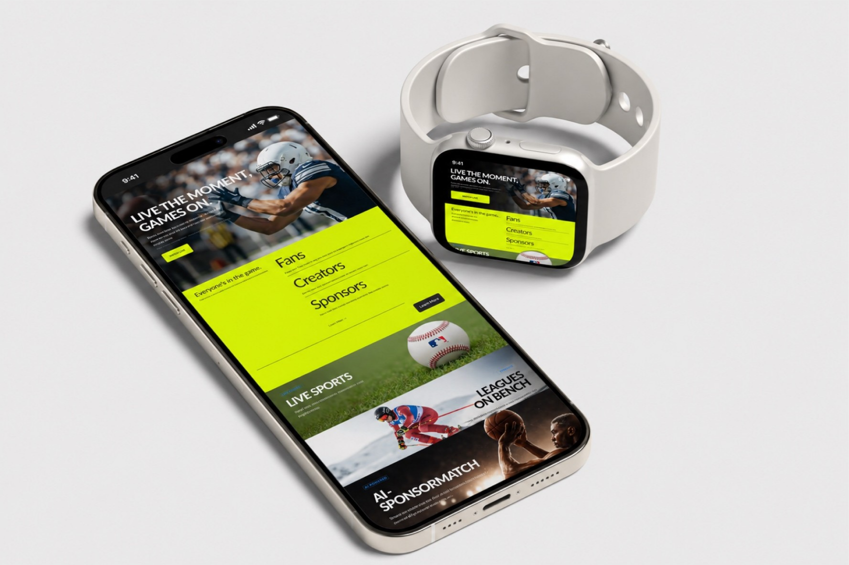
Do fans need an account to start watching? –

How does Bench support sponsors and brands? –

Which devices can I use with Bench? –

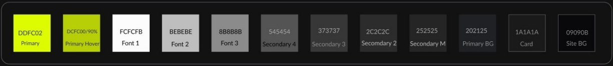
Do streamers need broadcast rights? –

Bench Sports Media © Community Guidelines Cookie Policy Privacy PolicyTerms Terms of Service Accessibility Statement Help Contact


9:41
LIVE THE MOMENT, GAMES ON.
WATCH LIVE
Everyone's in the game.
Fans
Creators
Sponsors
Learn More
LIVE SPORTS
LEAGUES ON BENCH
AI-SPONSORMATCH
AI POWERED

Design System

Colors



DDFC02	DCFC00/90%	FCFCFB	BEBEBE	8B8B8B	545454	373737	2C2C2C	252525	202125	1A1A1A	09090B
Primary	Primary Hover	Font 1	Font 2	Font 3	Secondary 4	Secondary 3	Secomdary 2	Secondary M	Primary BG	Card	Site BG

Typography- Font Style : Lato

Enter your email - Font main color

Enter your email - Font color2

Enter your email - Font color3

Display Large - Regular 57/64 . 0

Display Medium - Regular 45/52 . 0

Display Small - Regular 36/44 . 0

Headline Large - Regular 32/40 . 0

Headline Medium - Regular 28/36 . 0

Headline Small - Regular 24/32 . 0

Title Large - Regular 22/28 . 0

Title Medium - Regular 16/24 . +0.15

Title Small - Regular 14/20 . +0.1

Title Large - Medium 22/28/500 . 0

Title Medium - Semibold 16/24/600 . +0.15

Title Small - Medium 500 14/20 . +0.1

Label Large - Semibold 14/20/600 . +0.1

Label Medium - Semibold 12/16 . +0.5

Label Small - Semiboldold 11/16 . +0.5

Body x-Large - Lato Regular 18/24 . +0.5

Body Large - Lato Regular 16/24 . +0.5

Body Medium - Lato Regular 14/20 . +0.25

Body Small - Lato Regular 12/16 . +0.4

Body Large - Lato Regular 16/24 . +0.5

Body Medium - Lato Regular 14/20 . +0.25

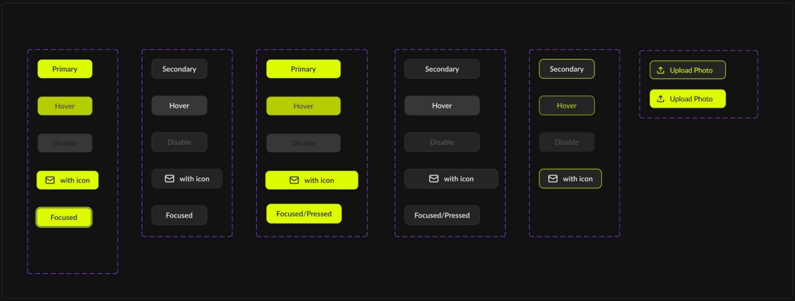
Body Small - Lato Regular 12/16 . +0.4

Body Large - Lato Regular 16/24 . +0.5

Body Medium - Lato Regular 14/20 . +0.25

Body Small - Lato Regular 12/16 . +0.4

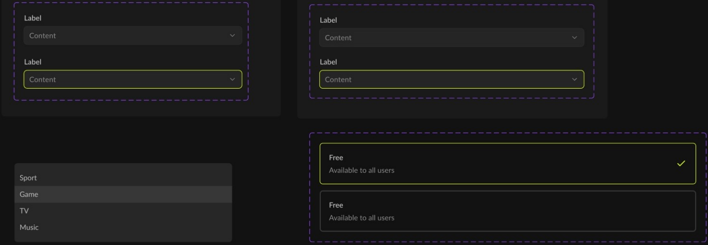
Button


Primary
Hover
Disable
with icon
Focused
Secondary
Hover
Disable
with icon
Focused
Primary
Hover
Disable
with icon
Focused/Pressed
Secondary
Hover
Disable
with icon
Focused/Pressed
Secondary
Hover
Disable
with icon
Upload Photo
Upload Photo

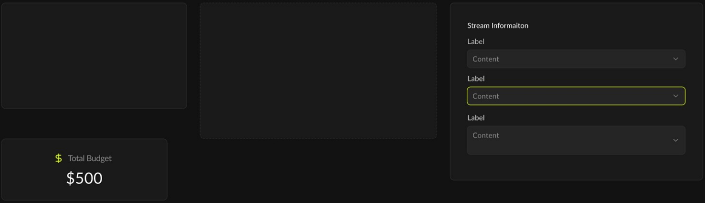
Input

Default State

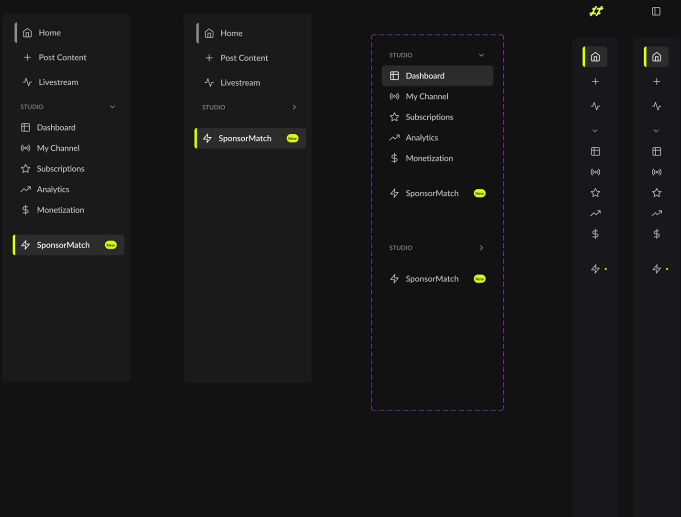
Default State/ Large


Label
Content
Label
Content
Label
Content
Label
Content
Sport
Game
TV
Music
Free
Available to all users
Free
Available to all users

Card


Stream Informaiton
Label
Content
Label
Content
Label
Content
$ Total Budget
$500

SideBarNav


Home
Post Content
Livestream
STUDIO
Dashboard
My Channel
Subscriptions
Analytics
Monetization
SponsorMatch
New
Home
Post Content
Livestream
STUDIO
SponsorMatch
New
STUDIO
Dashboard
My Channel
Subscriptions
Analytics
Monetization
SponsorMatch
New
STUDIO
SponsorMatch
New

Radio button & Group

● Label
Description

○ Label
Description

● Label
Description

● Label
Description

Toggle

Tab bar

All(10) | New matches(3) | Active(2) | Completed(5)

All (7) | New Matches (3) | Active (2) | Completed (2)

Checkbox & Checkbox Group

Default State

☑ Option 1
☑ Option 1
☐ Option 1

Horizontal Layout

☑ Option 1 ☑ Option 1 ☐ Option 1

Error State

☑ Option 1
☑ Option 1
☐ Option 1

Disabled State

☑ Option 1
☑ Option 1
☐ Option 1

Progress Bar

Progress 35%

Badges

Standard Badges

Default | Success | Pending | Error | Info | ✓ Completed | ✓ Completed | 80% Match | ✓ Active

New

Pro | Enterprise

Bronze | Silver | Gold | Platinum

Free Tier | Pro Tier | Enterprise Tier

Bronze Tier | Silver Tier | Gold Tier | Platinum Tier

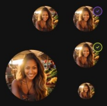
Chat box

LM Hi! I've uploaded the first video. Let me know if you need any changes.
2:15 PM

Looks great! Thanks for the quick turnaround.
2:15 PM

LM Thanks for the update!
2:15 PM

Type a message..



N

N

Divider

Footer

Bench Sports Media © Community Guidelines Cookie Policy Privacy PolicyTerms Terms of Service Accessibility Statement Help Contact

Bench Sports Media ©	Security	Help
Community Guidelines	Privacy PolicyTerms	Contact
Cookie Policy	Terms of Service	Accessibility Statement

Cards

Zeth Series New Matches

Duration: 3 Weeks

Budget: $7,500

Status: New Matches

5 Creators | Avg CTR: 3.1%

+2

View Details

85% Match

Tina Jonson

@tina_runner

✓ Sports content ✓ 10K+ followers

✓ Weekly uploads ✓ Creative Storytelling

Shortlist View Profile

Tina Jonson

@tina_runner

80% Done

✓ Sports content ✓ 10K+ followers

✓ Weekly uploads ✓ Creative Storytelling

View Overview

85% Match

Tina Jonson

@tina_runner

Pending

✓ Sports content ✓ 10K+ followers

✓ Weekly uploads ✓ Creative Storytelling

Invited

85% Match

Tina Jonson

@tina_runner

Shortlisted

✓ Sports content ✓ 10K+ followers

✓ Weekly uploads ✓ Creative Storytelling

Invite

Campaign

Zeth

80% Match

Feature Nike basketball shoes in your content

Zeth

80% Match

Feature Nike basketball shoes in your content

Calendar

March 2026

D	S	T	Q	Q	S	S
	1	2	3	4	5	20

Type

Product Placement

Duration

◷ 30 days

Payout

$500

Requirements

✓ Sports content

✓ 10K+ followers

✓ Weekly uploads

Accept

Decline

Type

Product Placement

Duration

◷ 30 days

Payout

$500

See more >

7	8	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26	27
28	29	30	31			

Accordion

Can I choose the creators I sponsor? +

Can I choose the creators I sponsor? −

Yes — you can browse and match with creators via BENCH Match.
If you..

Can I choose the creators I sponsor? +